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PITCH DECK · SEPTEMBER 2026

A coach you talk to, for the debt you don’t talk about.

Sproutjar is a financial wellness app for salaried people across the GCC. Ren, an AI voice coach trained on life coaching and positive psychology, sees your balances, holds your plan with you and turns paying off cards into a habit that outlives the debt.



Bisma Munawar · Dubai, United Arab Emirates · sproutjar.app

THE PROBLEM

Everyone in debt already knows what to do. The plan fails in month three.

Pay the expensive card first, stop adding to it, don’t miss a minimum. Nobody needs another calculator. What breaks people is the third month: a car repair or a school fee lands, the plan falls apart, and they quietly stop opening the app. Debt is a habit problem wearing a maths costume.

WHAT A GULF CARD COSTS A YEAR

12% to 44%

Quoted as 1% to 3.69% a month so it sounds like nothing. Emirates NBD works its own examples at 3.25% and 3.69% a month, Saudi cards sit near 36%, Qatar’s salary-transfer cards at 12%.

GRACE PERIOD IF YOU PAY MOST, NOT ALL

0 days

Interest runs from the transaction date unless 100% is paid by the due date. People paying nearly everything believe they are being responsible, and are not.

WHO PEOPLE CAN SAY THE NUMBER TO

Nobody

Debt is not discussed with family, friends or colleagues anywhere in the Gulf. It isn’t shame that keeps people stuck, but it is shame that keeps them silent.

Sources: published schedules of charges from Emirates NBD, Citibank UAE, QNB, Commercial Bank, Doha Bank and QIB; Saudi issuer terms; 25 first person UAE accounts; CBUAE Consumer Protection Regulation. Full sourcing at sproutjar.app/case-study.

WHAT THE RESEARCH SAID

The stated need is a number. The real need is a sequence that survives a bad month, and someone in the loop.

01 25 first person accounts from Gulf debt threads, mostly UAE, plus the bank tariffs in the UAE, Qatar and Saudi and the CBUAE rulebook, read before a line of code. Sources kept in separate buckets: researched, synthetic, assumed.

02 My starting assumption, that shame is why people stay stuck, was contradicted as a primary explanation. Job loss, illness, family expenses, cash-flow mismatch and habit all appear. The product changed shape because of it.

03 The one alternative that works is a human coach. It does not scale, and almost nobody can afford it.

04 Five synthetic interviews, two sceptics and one refuser among them, produced the buying objections the product now has to answer.

> **One person paid about USD 3,000 for six sessions with a human coach, and said the accountability was 90% of the value.**

First person account from the research. The single strongest signal that people will pay for accountability, and a single case.

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WHAT SPROUTJAR IS

Habit formation, life coaching and no-shame positive psychology, delivered by a voice that already knows your numbers.

Ren runs real coaching sessions, not chats. Ask before you teach. Reflect the person’s own words back. Help them decide, then hold the decision. Every call ends with one commitment in the person’s own words, and the next call opens on it.

01
Understand
What you owe, what the money is for, what you’ve already done right.

02
Plan
A payoff order and a date, from your own salary, payday and obligations.

03
Act
One commitment per call, written to the screen, checked on payday.

04
Adapt
A bad month gets a re-plan, not a restart. No red, no alarms, no scores.

05
Continue
After the last card, the same amount fills a reserve, then savings jars.

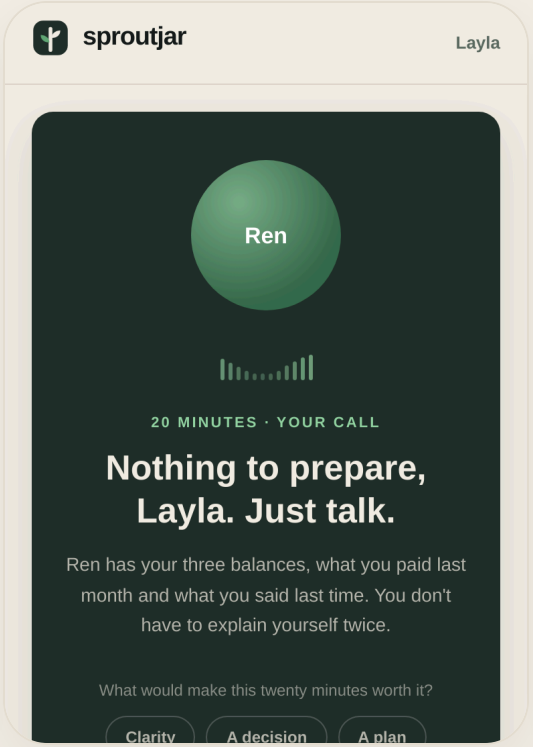
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THE PRODUCT, LIVE TODAY

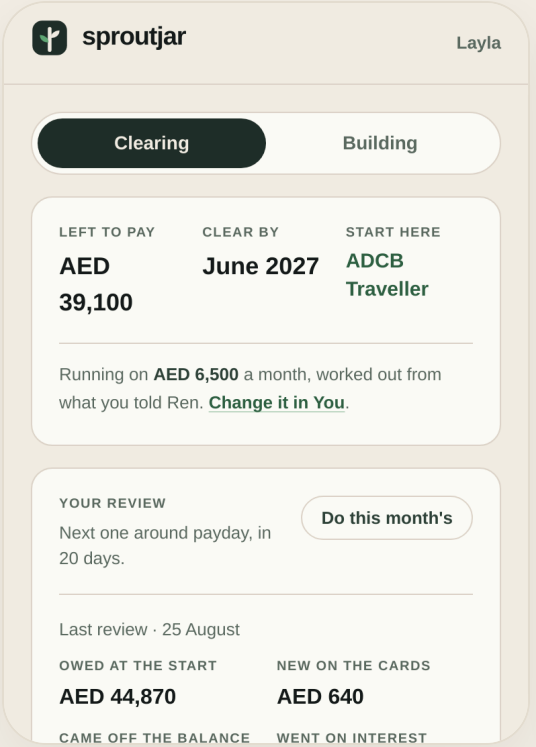
Four surfaces. Today, Ren, Plan, You. All of them instrumentation for one relationship.



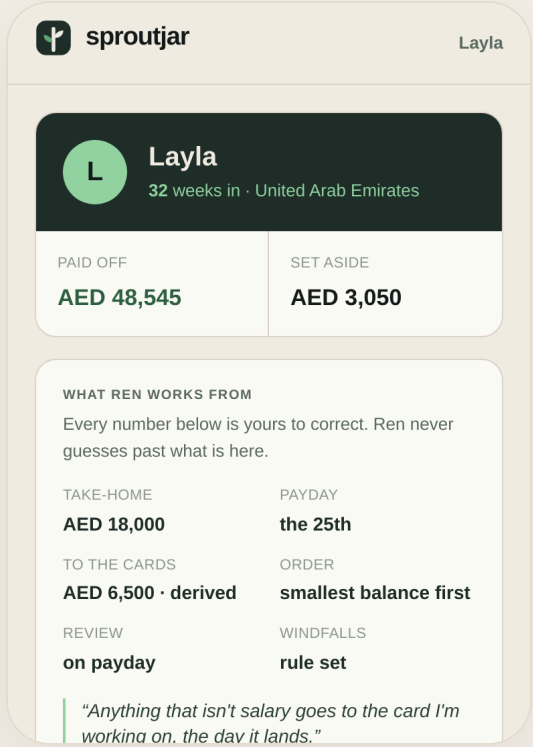
Today. The date, the principal cleared, the rent on the debt, this week's commitment.



Ren. Nothing to prepare. Pick a length and an intent, or type if you can't talk.



Plan. The payday review in four numbers, the cards, what comes after the last one.



You. Every number Ren works from, yours to correct.

Screens from the seeded demo profile (Layla, 32 weeks in). Not a customer.

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HOW A COACHING CALL WORKS

Nothing to prepare, one thing decided, and the app already updated when you hang up.

BEFORE

The app sets the agenda, you pick the length

- Today shows what’s live: the payday review if it’s due, a transfer question if interest is beating principal, last call’s commitment.
- Six coaching agendas, 10 to 40 minutes, each with a technique: getting clear, looking ahead, looking back, what works, what matters, finding support. Or "something else".
- First time only, a contract: what Ren will do, what it never does, tap Understood. Ren reads the live snapshot before it speaks, so you never explain yourself.

DURING

Coaching first, teaching when asked

- Opens on the last commitment: what did you intend, what did you do, what got in the way. Never "why did you fail".
- Reflects your words back, asks permission before it explains or pushes back, switches to plain education only when you ask.
- Pulls your numbers as tools: balances, payoff plan, card mechanics, a transfer offer read live from the bank’s own site.
- Can’t talk? Type. Same Ren, same memory. Silence is allowed; Ren waits.

AFTER

The call writes itself into the product

- One commitment in your words, with its trigger, on Today. Or an honest "nothing landed this time".
- Beliefs you voiced about money are kept and shown back on You. The next agenda is already suggested from what came up.
- A transfer Ren explored lands on Plan as a proposal with the bank’s terms, source and time. It stays a proposal until you apply it.
- Nothing moves without you. Ren never touches money, never marks anything done, never scores you.

Product thinking: agency before advice, proposals never look completed until confirmed, and the coach should be needed less over time, not more.

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HOW A MONTH GOES

Payday is when the money decision happens. The product shows up then, and stays out of the way otherwise.

Payday

Still right this month?

"You decided AED 6,500 goes to the cards. Still right?" Yes, less this month, or talk it through. An invitation, never an alarm.

Review

Four numbers

Where the debt started, anything new borrowed, principal repaid, interest burned. The date moves, and the person sees why.

Call

One commitment

Ren opens on what you said last time and what happened. The call ends with one thing you'll do, in your words, or an honest "nothing landed".

When it's worth it

Cheaper debt, as a question

If interest is beating principal, Ren raises a balance transfer with the bank's own published terms attached. It stays a proposal until you apply it.

After

The habit outlives the debt

When the last card clears, the same monthly amount fills a small reserve, then the savings jars, with dates already on screen.

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WHY THIS AND NOT WHAT EXISTS

Not a budgeting app. Not ChatGPT with a money prompt. A coach that scales.

	BUDGETING APPS	GENERAL CHATBOTS	HUMAN COACH	SPROUTJAR
Knows your live balances	**Yes**	No	Only what you bring	**Yes**
Remembers what you committed to	No	Starts from zero	**Yes**	**Yes**
Asks what happened on payday	Notifications	No	**Yes**	**Yes**
Built for Gulf card mechanics	US rates, US grace	Generic	Depends	**GCC, each bank's own terms**
Behavioural method	Streaks, scores, red	None	**Coaching**	**Coaching, no shame**
Cost	Free to ~USD 15 / month	Free to USD 20 / month	~USD 500 / session	USD 10.6 / month ASSUMPTION

Field pricing from the market research. Human coach figure from a single first person account. Sproutjar price is unvalidated.

BUILT FOR HOW GCC CARDS ACTUALLY WORK

Dubai, Riyadh and Doha price the same habit very differently. The product reads each bank’s own terms.

ISSUER	REVOLVING RATE	MINIMUM DUE	LATE FEE	CASH ADVANCE
UAE, typical Emirates NBD, Citibank UAE	3.25% to 3.69% a month 39% to 44% a year	Per card	Rate rises +0.5% a month if late twice in six months (Emirates NBD)	No grace, interest from day one
Saudi, typical Major issuers	36.28% to 36.75% a year	Per card	Per card	Per card
QNB Qatar	1% a month · 12% a year	Per card	0.25% a month	4%, min QR 10, no grace
Commercial Bank Qatar	1% a month with salary transfer 2.25% a month · 27% a year without	3%	0.25% or QAR 100, whichever greater	4% to 4.5% by network
Doha Bank Qatar	1% a month · 12% a year	Per card	QR 100 or 0.25%, whichever higher	4.5% or QR 20, whichever higher
QIB Qatar, Islamic	1% a month profit · 12% a year	5%	2% charity commitment	3%

Read from each bank’s published tariff or product page; Qatar rows retrieved 5 September 2026, UAE from the schedules cited in the case study. Rates are shown as simple annualisation of the monthly figure. Every row in the product carries its source URL and retrieval date.

BUSINESS MODEL ASSUMPTIONS, MARKED AS SUCH

A subscription for accountability, not arithmetic. Small numbers, two things to prove.

PRICE

USD 10.6 / mo

About AED 39. Inside the free-to-15 field so the decision is easy; the thing being bought is the coaching relationship. Unvalidated.

BREAK-EVEN

~1,840

Paying customers, on a solo cost base of roughly USD 234K a year: founder draw, voice and LLM cost, infrastructure, small paid acquisition.

SUCCESS

~3,930

Paying customers, about USD 500K ARR. In three years that is roughly 109 net new a month.

BIGGEST UNKNOWN

Retention

If people leave when the debt clears, the base drains every 18 months. If savings mode keeps them, acquisition need halves.

CHANNELS

Organic and LLM search on the rates and rights research, which almost nobody publishes. A little paid. And the one that changes the economics: financial wellness as an employer or bank benefit, where one partnership delivers hundreds.

WHAT TURNS THIS FROM MARGINAL TO WORKING

10+ real people paying USD 10.6 for two months. Evidence that graduated users still open the app in month 20. One employer or bank conversation.

WHERE IT IS TODAY

Live product, no users yet. Every figure here is research or the seeded demo, and I say which.

LIVE SINCE

30 Aug 2026

Live database, live voice calls, a payoff engine doing real month by month amortisation at each card's own rate. UAE and Qatar terms in the product, Saudi researched.

BUILT

1 person, ~1 week

Research, positioning, brand, coaching design, interface and code, using AI tooling end to end. A public case study documents each step.

STRESS TESTED

1 independent audit

A UX audit tore the first version apart. The action loop, the review ritual and the You screen were rebuilt against it.

USERS

0

Seeded demo profile only.

REVENUE

0

Pre-revenue.

NEXT

10+ paying

Paying, run concierge if needed, to test the price and whether the coaching holds.

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WHY THE GCC, WHY QATAR, WHY THIS PROGRAM

The GCC is one market: salaried expats, cards here, money sent home. Qatar is where I start.

01 Six countries, one customer. Expats are the bulk of the Gulf's private workforce: on salary transfer, two to four cards, a remittance home every month, nobody to say the number to. Ren is keyed on the person's country; UAE and Qatar cards are priced from each bank's own page today, Saudi is researched.

02 Qatar has that same expat workforce sending money home while carrying cards here, and the central bank caps repayments at half of salary. Cards are cheaper, about 12% a year against Dubai's 44%, but the habit problem is identical: the plan still dies on a bad month.

03 Qatar is also where the riba-free side belongs. When someone tells Ren that avoiding riba matters to them, the plan is held in that frame, and QIB already replaces a late fee with a 2% charity commitment.

04 The channel that changes the economics is financial wellness as an employer or bank benefit, where one partnership delivers hundreds. Qatar's ecosystem, QSTP and QDB included, is where that first conversation lives, and Doha is the doorway to the rest of the GCC.

WHAT I WANT FROM THE PROGRAM

- 10+ real people paying and using it for two months.
- Find out whether people stay after the debt is cleared.
- One employer or bank wellness conversation in Doha.
- The Qatar regulatory posture for a coaching product that never moves money.
- From a solo builder to a team.

Not legal advice. Published Qatar Central Bank caps and Ren customer count as of late. Card terms from QNB, Commercial Bank, Doha Bank and QIB published pages, 5 September 2026.

TEAM

Bisma Munawar, founder.

Senior Product Designer, seven years across aviation, telecom and banking, including Qatar Airways and Ooredoo Qatar. BSc Information Systems with an HCI specialisation from Carnegie Mellon.

- On Sproutjar, did the research, positioning, brand, coaching design, interface and the code, working with AI agents as the engineering team.
- Ran the idea past a deliberately sceptical research process; it contradicted the central assumption and the product changed shape.
- Read the coaching evidence before writing a line of the coach. Sproutjar describes itself as structured support for behaviour change, never a cure.

BUILT WITH

Next.js and Convex for the app and live data. ElevenLabs for Ren’s voice. Context.dev for live, source-backed bank terms. Vercel. Devin and Claude for the build, a PR per change.

CONTACT

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HOW I RESEARCHED, DESIGNED AND BUILT IT

Research first, a brief and a PRD before a screen, then built with AI agents as the engineering team.

01

Research

25 first person accounts, bank tariffs in the UAE, Qatar and Saudi, the CBUAE rulebook, and five synthetic interviews with a sceptical advisor prompt. Sources kept in separate buckets: researched, synthetic, assumed.

02

Brief and PRD

Who it is for, the coaching method, the legal posture, the banned language. 42 numbered features, with unhappy paths weighted like happy ones.

03

Brand and flows

Logo, palette, the plant animation, Nunito everywhere. Four journeys mapped before a screen: onboarding, the session, post call, the month that broke.

04

Voice and build

Ren trained in ElevenLabs from the coaching research. Next.js and the payoff engine built with Devin, a PR per change, live balances in Convex, bank offers read live via Context.dev.

05

Ship and stress test

Deployed on Vercel, the whole journey recorded, then an independent UX audit that tore the first version apart. The action loop, review ritual and You screen were rebuilt against it.

FULL CASE STUDY

Every figure marked as research, synthetic or seeded demo, with the sources, the Qatar card terms and the design tokens.

sproutjar.app/case-study

Progress is the principal you cleared, and a plant that never wilts.

The plan was never the hard part. Someone noticing you kept it is. Sproutjar is that someone, for the salaried people across the Gulf who have nobody to say the number to.